airguides



SMALL-GROUP OCEAN EXPEDITION

Dominica: Swim with Sperm Whales

Five days at sea with Karim Iliya, local captains and an experienced crew. Warm Caribbean water, wild sperm whales, and a group limited to just six guests.

SEASON	DURATION	GROUP SIZE	PRICE
April 2027	7 Days / 6 Nights	Max 6 Guests	US$7,500

HIGHLIGHTS

Five days built around one of the ocean's rarest encounters

01

Five Days at Sea

Repeated days on the water give the group the strongest possible chance of natural, unhurried sperm whale encounters.

02

Six Guests Only

A deliberately small group keeps the experience calm, personal and respectful in and out of the water.

03

Wild Sperm Whales

Watch for blows, listen for clicks and enter the water only when conditions and whale behaviour allow.

04

Karim Iliya

Learn alongside a wildlife photographer, filmmaker and conservationist whose work has appeared in National Geographic and BBC Earth.

05

Warm Caribbean Water

Snorkel in clear tropical water off one of the few places on Earth where these whales can be encountered this way.

06

Wild Dominica

Rainforest, waterfalls, volcanic landscapes and island culture surround the days spent searching offshore.

ABOUT THE EXPERIENCE

Meet the largest toothed predators on the planet, on their terms

Dominica is one of the few places on Earth where sperm whales can be encountered in warm, clear Caribbean water.

Each morning, you will head out with Karim, a local captain and an experienced crew who know these waters and how to read whale behaviour. The search is part of the experience: scanning for blows, listening for clicks and waiting for the right moment.

When conditions and the whales allow, you will slip into the water quietly. You may encounter mothers and calves near the surface, social groups moving through the blue, or whales communicating through the clicks and codas that carry across the ocean.

Nothing is staged and no sighting is guaranteed. That honesty is what makes a real encounter so powerful.



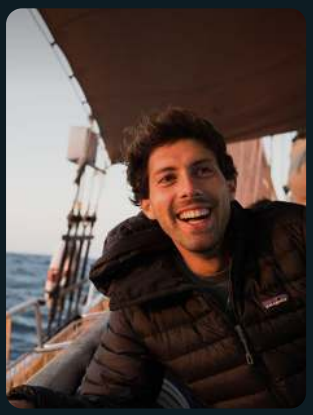
Every day is different. Some moments are brief. Others stay with you for life.

"I felt like I was on a National Geographic guided trip. Karim and the team were so knowledgeable about these magnificent creatures."

Nicollette C

YOUR STORYTELLER GUIDE

Karim Iliya



Karim Iliya

WILDLIFE PHOTOGRAPHER, FILMMAKER AND CONSERVATIONIST

Karim's work offers a rare glimpse into the lives of some of Earth's most compelling species. From swimming with whales to filming volcanic eruptions from above, his images have appeared in National Geographic, BBC Earth and leading global publications.

He brings more than technical mastery. His approach is grounded in patience, instinct and a deep respect for the natural world. In Dominica, he is beside you in the water and behind the lens, helping you understand behaviour, improve your underwater photography and stay present for the encounter itself.

> *"Photography lets me see the Earth in a new way, where I take my time looking at the details that you don't usually see." - Karim Iliya*



WHY THIS TRIP?

Time, patience and the right people on the water

Wildlife does not work to a timetable. That is why this expedition gives you five full days at sea instead of reducing the experience to one rushed attempt.

The local captain and crew bring deep knowledge of Dominica's waters. Karim brings years of experience around whales and a thoughtful approach to underwater storytelling. The six-guest limit keeps every day personal.

The goal is not to chase an image at any cost. It is to understand what you are seeing, move with respect and be ready when a rare, natural encounter unfolds.






DAY BY DAY

Your 7-day Dominica expedition

DAY 1

Welcome to Dominica

ARRIVAL

Arrive at Douglas Charles Airport, where you will be met and transferred to The Champs Hotel in Portsmouth. Meet Karim, your Airguides host and the local team for an evening orientation covering safety, whale days, in-water etiquette and the rhythm of the week.

DAYS 2–3

The Search Begins

AT SEA

After breakfast, head to the dock for your first full days at sea. Spend around six hours on the water watching for blows, listening for clicks and entering the water only when conditions and the whales allow. Packed lunches keep the group close to the action.

DAY 4

Whales, Photography and Island Time

AT SEA

Return to the water with a better feel for the patience, signals and silence behind every encounter. Karim helps you refine your approach, whether that means stronger underwater images or simply learning to stay present.

DAYS 5–6

Back on the Water

AT SEA

Two more full sea days create the best chance of varied encounters. You may see mothers with calves, social groups, juveniles, or hear the deep communication clicks and codas that sperm whales are known for.

DAY 7

Farewell Dominica

DEPARTURE

After breakfast, transfer back to Douglas Charles Airport. Leave with full memory cards, a deeper understanding of sperm whales and the rare feeling of having shared the water with one of the ocean's most intelligent animals.

YOUR BASE

Six nights in Portsmouth

The Champs Hotel is your base between days on the water, set above Portsmouth on Dominica's north-west coast.

Mornings begin with breakfast before the group heads to the dock. Packed lunches are taken on the boat, while evenings are relaxed and social over shared dinners at the hotel or a local restaurant, depending on the final schedule.

Late afternoons leave room to rest, review images, swim or explore more of Dominica's rainforest, coastline and island culture.



6	5	6	1
nights in Portsmouth	full days at sea	guest maximum	rare ocean expedition

THE DETAILS

What's included

Included

- Six nights shared accommodation at The Champs Hotel
- Five full days at sea with a local captain and experienced crew
- In-water guidance and underwater photography support from Karim Iliya
- Breakfasts and dinners at the hotel
- Packed lunches on whale days
- Airport pickup and drop-off at Douglas Charles Airport
- Local trip transport and listed activities
- Airguides expedition support before and during the journey

Wildlife encounters and time in the water always depend on whale behaviour, weather, safety and local conditions.

Not Included

- International and domestic flights to Dominica
- Snorkelling gear and personal water equipment
- Travel, medical and evacuation insurance
- Optional activities outside the listed itinerary
- Alcoholic drinks
- Private room single supplement
- Tips, gratuities and personal expenses

FAQ

What guests usually need to know

Are sperm whale encounters guaranteed?

No. These are wild animals and every day at sea is different. Sightings and in-water encounters cannot be scripted or guaranteed, and entering the water always depends on conditions and whale behaviour. Five full days at sea with experienced local captains, crew and Karim give you the strongest possible chance of a respectful, natural encounter.

Do I need to be a photographer?

No. The photography and filmmaking guidance is optional. Some guests come to improve their images, while others come purely for the experience of being in the water with whales.

Do I need scuba certification?

No. Encounters are by snorkelling and, when appropriate, optional freediving. You should be a confident swimmer and comfortable snorkelling in open water.

What is the group size?

The expedition is limited to six guests. The small group keeps boat days personal and supports calm, respectful encounters.

How do I get to Dominica?

Fly into Douglas Charles Airport, airport code DOM. Airport pickup and drop-off are included, and the Airguides team can help with flight routing before you book.

PRICING & DATES

Choose your 2027 departure

TRIP PRICE

US$7,500

Per person in USD for seven days and six nights in Dominica.

DEPOSIT

25%

Reserve with 25% now and pay the remaining balance later, subject to the final booking terms.

- 13 April to 19 April 2027 (Confirmed)
- 18 April to 24 April 2027 (Confirmed)
- 24 April to 30 April 2027 (Pre-registration)
- 29 April to 5 May 2027 (Pre-registration)

Availability, room type and final inclusions should be confirmed with Airguides at the time of booking.

READY?

Five days at sea. Six guests. One rare chance to meet wild sperm whales.

Get in touch to check availability, talk through flights and choose the right 2027 departure.

Check Dates & Availability

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